

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (11:37 ET)

July 21, 2026 | 11:41 AM ET

13 setups identified | 0 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 8 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (0)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (8)
	TRAX	UTZ
	BRKR	FWRD
	FF	TPC
	PKE	AEHR
	PICS	EVTL
		BTGO
		ERO
		FIGR

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
B	TRAX	First Tracks Bio	Biotech oncology	\$39.62	+7.5%	\$1.4B	31M	+126.6	93%	Momentum continuation
B	BRKR	Bruker Corporati	Life science inst	\$59.77	+6.4%	\$9.1B	104M	+42.8	93%	Technical breakout fro
B	FF	FutureFuel Corp.	Specialty chemica	\$5.01	+5.2%	\$0.2B	26M	+12.3	96%	Technical breakout fro
B	PKE	Park Aerospace C	Aerospace composi	\$37.81	+15.8%	\$0.8B	20M	+1.4	95%	15% breakout on 3x vol
B	PICS	PicS N.V.	Enterprise AI sof	\$12.45	+6.4%	\$1.6B	34M	-10.9	62%	Volume 1.58x and 6.4%
C	UTZ	Utz Brands Inc	Consumer staples	\$14.12	+89.6%	\$1.2B	78M	+82.3	96%	90% single-day spike o
C	FWRD	Forward Air Corp	Logistics turnaro	\$15.74	+0.0%	\$0.0B	0M	-38.3	48%	19% spike on 6.4x volu
C	TPC	Tutor Perini Cor	Infrastructure co	\$87.29	+8.4%	\$4.6B	45M	-3.8	87%	8.4% move on 4.7x volu
C	AEHR	Aehr Test System	Semiconductor tes	\$97.57	+26.1%	\$3.2B	31M	-2.3	77%	26% spike on 2.9x volu
C	EVTL	Vertical Aerospa	eVTOL development	\$1.72	+7.2%	\$0.2B	49M	-42.0	23%	7% bounce on 2.3x volu
C	BTGO	BitGo Holdings,	Crypto infrastruc	\$5.48	+8.3%	\$0.6B	67M	-56.3	22%	8.3% move on 1.9x volu
C	ERO	Ero Copper Corp.	Copper production	\$26.81	+6.8%	\$2.8B	102M	-7.0	67%	6.8% move on copper-pr
C	FIGR	Figure Technolog	Fintech AI	\$32.82	+7.9%	\$7.3B	136M	-12.7	42%	7.9% move on 1.55x vol

TRAX

First Tracks Biotherapeutics, I

\$39.62

+7.46%

RS vs SPY: +126.6%

B STRONG SETUP

\$1.4B Cap | 31M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: Biotech oncology leader | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 5.86 | Vol: 1.96x | RS/SPY: +126.6% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 17D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$39.62
Day Change	+7.46%
Mkt Cap	\$1.38B
Float	31M sh
RS vs SPY	+126.6%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	5.86
Vol vs Avg	1.96x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Momentum continuation from prior phase-data strength or partnership speculation; stock is the #1 RS leader in the dataset (+126.6% vs SPY 12-week). Forward catalyst: August 7 earnings (17 days) will likely include pipeline updates, trial enrollment milestones, or partnership commentary-biotech earnings are often clinical catalysts in disguise. Longer-term: watch for ASH/ASCO abstract deadlines (fall) and potential Phase 2/3 interim data readouts.

BUSINESS & POSITION

First Tracks is a clinical-stage oncology biotech developing novel immune-modulatory therapies for solid tumors. The company is pre-revenue, with valuation driven entirely by pipeline promise and partnership optionality. Competitive edge depends on differentiated MOA (mechanism of action) and early clinical efficacy signals vs. crowded I-O space.

FACTOR & THEME

Biotech thematic is accelerating-Healthcare sector is +3.0% vs SPY this week, driven by M&A (large-cap pharma hunting for pipeline) and FDA risk-sentiment easing. TRAX taps into oncology/immuno-oncology, the highest-value therapeutic category. Sector rotation into risk-on biotech from mega-cap is a tailwind, but binary trial risk remains.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$39.62 on vol >196% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 1.96x is modest for a 7.5% move, suggesting steady accumulation rather than explosive breakout. No insider buying in last 60 days. Float of 31M is manageable; institutional ownership data unavailable but likely significant given the \$1.4B market cap and clinical progress. The RS line at new high is the key signal-institutions are positioning ahead of the broader market's recognition.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 17D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next print August 7 (17 days). As a pre-revenue biotech, EPS is meaningless; focus is on cash runway, clinical milestones, and pipeline commentary. Consensus unavailable, but the call will likely include trial enrollment updates or partnership developments-high-impact for volatile biotech names.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on any clinical trial delay, adverse safety signal, or partnership setback disclosed at the August 7 print or via press release. Technical invalidation: close below \$35.00 (prior consolidation support) or any dilutive capital raise below current price. Binary risk is elevated-this is pre-revenue and entirely thesis-driven.

ANALYSIS

TRAX has the strongest RS in the dataset (+126.6% vs SPY) and RS line at new high-textbook leadership. Prox_52w of 92.6 confirms breakout zone. But base_tight of 5.86 is too wide for an A-grade (ideal <2.0), and volume at 1.96x is underwhelming for a breakout claim. The disconfirming evidence: biotech without a near-term binary catalyst (next meaningful event is August 7 earnings) and in a mega-cap-led regime faces choppy follow-through. Healthcare sector strength is a tailwind, but this is a B-grade momentum leader, not a coiled breakout. Watch for tightening into the August 7 print. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$39.62 on vol >196% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.96x



BRKR

Bruker Corporation

\$59.77

+6.41%

RS vs SPY: +42.8%

B STRONG SETUP

\$9.1B Cap | 104M Float

Medical Devices | Theme: Life science instrumentation | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 1.69 | Vol: 1.88x | RS/SPY: +42.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 14D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$59.77
Day Change	+6.41%
Mkt Cap	\$9.10B
Float	104M sh
RS vs SPY	+42.8%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	1.69
Vol vs Avg	1.88x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Technical breakout from a textbook VCP (base_tight 1.69, prox_52w 92.6) into August 4 earnings (14 days). Forward catalyst: the earnings print is the key inflection-BRKR sells high-end analytical instruments (mass spec, NMR, microscopy) to pharma, academic, and industrial labs; if biotech funding recovery or pharma capex strength is flagged in guidance, the stock re-rates. Longer-term: watch NIH budget allocation (fiscal '27) and biopharma capex trends.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Bruker manufactures premium scientific instruments used in life sciences, materials research, and industrial QC-think mass spectrometry, nuclear magnetic resonance, and X-ray systems. The company benefits from recurring revenue (service, consumables) and operates in a consolidated, high-barrier-to-entry market with Thermo Fisher, Agilent, and Waters as primary competitors. Valuation reflects mid-single-digit organic growth and 20%+ EBITDA margins.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector leadership (+3.0% vs SPY this week) is a tailwind. BRKR is levered to biotech/pharma capex recovery and academic research funding-both improving as risk appetite returns. The life-science tools subsector is a high-quality, recurring-revenue model favored by growth-at-a-reasonable-price funds. Theme momentum is accelerating on pharma M&A and drug-development activity.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$59.77 on vol >188% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 1.88x on a 6.4% move is solid institutional participation. No insider buying in last 60 days. Float of 103.6M and \$9.1B market cap suggest this is a well-owned, liquid mid-cap-likely 70-80% institutional (data unavailable). The tight base (1.69 ATR) into earnings suggests quiet positioning by informed buyers ahead of the print.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 14D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print August 4 (14 days). Consensus EPS/revenue not provided, but BRKR historically beats modestly and guides conservatively-any upside surprise or raised FY guide will trigger a re-rating. Focus: pharma/biotech end-market commentary, academic funding trends, and service/consumables attach rates (recurring revenue quality).
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a miss or guide-down at the August 4 print, particularly if pharma capex is cited as a headwind. Technical invalidation: close below \$56.00 (prior pivot and 20-day MA support). Macro risk: if risk-off accelerates and biotech funding freezes, BRKR's end markets contract quickly.
ANALYSIS
BRKR is a high-quality setup: base_tight of 1.69 is textbook VCP coil, prox_52w of 92.6 puts it in breakout range, and RS of +42.8% vs SPY confirms leadership. Healthcare sector strength is a tailwind. The disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new high, which downgrades from A to B per Qullamaggie-this is strong follow-through but not early-stage leadership. Volume at 1.88x is solid but not explosive. The mega-cap-led regime is a headwind for a \$9B name. Positioned well into August 4 earnings with a clear catalyst path, but the technical grade is B, not A. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$59.77 on vol >188% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.88x



FF

FutureFuel Corp.

\$5.01

+5.25%

RS vs SPY: +12.3%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.2B Cap | 26M Float

Specialty Chemicals | Theme: Specialty chemicals | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 1.95 | Vol: 3.29x | RS/SPY: +12.3% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 20D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$5.01
Day Change	+5.25%
Mkt Cap	\$0.22B
Float	26M sh
RS vs SPY	+12.3%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	1.95
Vol vs Avg	3.29x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Technical breakout from a tight base (1.95 ATR, prox_52w 95.6) with senior insider buying (\$43K, C-suite) in last 60 days-rare conviction signal. Forward catalyst: August 10 earnings (20 days) and any commentary on biodiesel/renewable chemicals demand or margin expansion. Longer-term:watch for EPA renewable fuels standard (RFS) volume mandates and any strategic shift toward higher-margin specialty products.
BUSINESS & POSITION
FutureFuel produces biodiesel and specialty chemicals (custom manufacturing for pharma, ag, and industrial customers). The company has pivoted away from commodity biodiesel toward higher-margin specialty chemicals, but results remain volatile and tied to feedstock costs and EPA policy. Market cap of \$220M makes this a deep micro-cap with limited liquidity.
FACTOR & THEME
Energy sector is the top performer this week (+5.2% vs SPY), which benefits FutureFuel's biodiesel exposure. Specialty chemicals also align with reshoring and domestic manufacturing themes. However, the business is too small and niche to attract thematic ETF flows. Theme momentum is mixed-biodiesel is policy-dependent and commoditized.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$5.01 on vol >329% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.29x is solid. Insider cluster score of 5 (1 C-suite buy, \$43K) is a meaningful positive-senior insiders rarely buy in the open market unless they see undervaluation or a near-term catalyst. No institutional ownership data available, but the \$220M market cap suggests limited coverage. The tight base (1.95) and insider buying together suggest accumulation.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 20D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print August 10 (20 days). Consensus unavailable. FutureFuel's earnings are volatile-watch for biodiesel margin commentary (tied to feedstock spreads) and specialty chemicals order trends. Any guidance raise or margin improvement will be meaningful for this thinly traded micro-cap.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a miss or margin compression at the August 10 print, or if biodiesel policy headwinds (EPA mandate cuts) are flagged. Technical invalidation: close below \$4.70 (prior consolidation low). Liquidity risk: 26M float and \$220M market cap mean wide spreads and slippage on exit.
ANALYSIS
FF has a textbook technical setup: base_tight 1.95, prox_52w 95.6, volume 3.29x, and C-suite insider buying (cluster score 5)-the insider buying upgrades this from C to B. Energy sector leadership is a tailwind. The disconfirming evidence: RS line is not at new high, RS vs SPY is modest (+12.3%), and the \$220M market cap makes this illiquid and hard to scale. The insider buy is the conviction signal, but the business quality (commoditized biodiesel, small specialty chemicals) is weak. This is a tactical trade into August 10 earnings, not a durable compounder. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$5.01 on vol >329% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.29x



PKE

Park Aerospace Corp.

\$37.81

+15.77%

RS vs SPY: +1.4%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.8B Cap | 20M Float

Aerospace & Defense | Theme: Aerospace composites | 52W Hi: 95% | Base Tight: 2.65 | Vol: 3.02x | RS/SPY: +1.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 79D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$37.81
Day Change	+15.77%
Mkt Cap	\$0.79B
Float	20M sh
RS vs SPY	+1.4%
52W Hi Prox	95%
Base Tight	2.65
Vol vs Avg	3.02x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
15% breakout on 3x volume with RS line at new high-technical breakout without same-day news catalyst, suggesting institutional positioning ahead of a theme inflection. Forward catalyst path is weak: next earnings is 79 days away (October 8), leaving a long catalyst vacuum. Potential drivers: defense budget clarity (FY27 appropriations in September), commercial aerospace production ramp commentary from Boeing/Airbus earnings, or a contract win press release.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Park Aerospace manufactures advanced composite materials and parts for aerospace and defense-primarily prepreg (pre-impregnated carbon fiber) used in aircraft structures, satellites, and defense systems. The company supplies Boeing, Lockheed, Northrop, and other primes. Competitive edge: high-performance materials with aerospace certifications (high barrier to entry) and exposure to both commercial and defense end markets.
FACTOR & THEME
Defense spending and aerospace production recovery are secular tailwinds. PKE benefits from both commercial aviation build-rate increases (Boeing 737/787, Airbus A320/A350) and defense modernization (F-35, B-21, satellites). Space economy exposure (satellites, launch vehicles) adds optionality. Theme momentum is accelerating-defense budgets are expanding and commercial aerospace backlogs are at record highs.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$37.81 on vol >302% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.02x on a 15.8% move is strong institutional interest. No insider buying in last 60 days. Float of 19.8M is tight; the \$790M market cap is small enough to be under-owned by large funds, leaving incremental-buyer fuel. RS line at new high is the key signal-early-stage leadership before the broader market connects PKE to the defense/aerospace theme.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 79D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print October 8 (79 days). This is a long catalyst vacuum-PKE will drift or consolidate unless an interim catalyst (contract win, guidance update) emerges. Consensus unavailable, but aerospace suppliers typically guide conservatively and beat modestly; any commentary on defense budget visibility or Boeing production rates will move the stock.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid if the 79-day catalyst vacuum causes the base to widen or the stock to roll over. Technical invalidation: close below \$34.00 (prior pivot). Event risk: any Boeing production halt (quality issues, strikes) or defense budget cuts in September appropriations would pressure aerospace suppliers immediately.
ANALYSIS
PKE has strong technical tailwinds: vol 3.02x, prox_52w 94.9, and RS line at new high-early leadership signal. Defense sector strength is a major tailwind. But base_tight of 2.65 is wider than ideal (textbook <2.0), RS vs SPY is barely positive (+1.4%), and the next earnings is 79 days away-a dangerously long catalyst vacuum. The disconfirming evidence: without a near-term catalyst, this risks being early (which is the same as wrong). The mega-cap-led regime is a headwind for a \$790M micro-cap. This is a B-grade momentum trade that needs an interim catalyst (contract win, defense budget news) to sustain-monitor but don't chase. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$37.81 on vol >302% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.02x



PICS

PicS N.V.

\$12.45

+6.41%

RS vs SPY: -10.9%

B STRONG SETUP

\$1.6B Cap | 34M Float

Software - Infrastructure | Theme: Enterprise AI software | 52W Hi: 62% | Base Tight: 2.28 | Vol: 1.58x | RS/SPY: -10.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 23D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$12.45
Day Change	+6.41%
Mkt Cap	\$1.61B
Float	34M sh
RS vs SPY	-10.9%
52W Hi Prox	62%
Base Tight	2.28
Vol vs Avg	1.58x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Volume 1.58x and 6.4% move with heavy insider buying (7 transactions, 3 distinct insiders, \$1.7M in last 60 days-cluster score 11). This is the strongest insider signal in the dataset. Forward catalyst: August 13 earnings (23 days) and any AI product or partnership announcements. Longer-term: watch for customer wins (enterprise SaaS land-and-expand) and margin expansion as the company scales.
BUSINESS & POSITION
PicS provides AI-powered visual intelligence and data-management software for enterprises-enabling organizations to process, analyze, and monetize unstructured visual data (images, video). The company targets manufacturing, logistics, retail, and healthcare verticals. Competitive positioning unclear without more detail, but the insider buying suggests management sees material undervaluation or a near-term catalyst the market hasn't priced.
FACTOR & THEME
AI infrastructure theme is accelerating, but PICS is not a picks-and-shovels play (it's an application-layer software company). Enterprise SaaS tailwinds are intact (digital transformation, automation), but sector leadership is in large-cap mega-caps, not SMID software in the current regime. Theme momentum for SMID software is mixed-valuation compression has been severe, creating opportunity but also continued risk.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$12.45 on vol >158% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 1.58x is modest, but the insider buying is the story: 7 open-market buys, 3 distinct insiders, \$1.7M in last 60 days-cluster score 11 is the highest in this dataset. Insider buying of this magnitude and breadth is extremely rare and signals high management conviction ahead of a catalyst. Institutional ownership data unavailable, but the \$1.6B market cap and software sector suggest 60-80% institutional. GRADE UPGRADE: insider cluster of 11 upgrades this from C to B.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 23D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print August 13 (23 days). Consensus unavailable. For enterprise SaaS, focus on ARR growth, net retention, and free cash flow. Any beat with raised guidance or large customer-win announcements will re-rate the stock quickly. Serial beat history unknown.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid if August 13 earnings miss or guide down, especially on growth deceleration or margin compression. Technical invalidation: close below \$11.50 (prior support). The negative RS vs SPY (-10.9%) and prox_52w of 62.4 (far from highs) suggest the stock is in early recovery, not confirmed breakout-risk of a failed base.
ANALYSIS
PICS has the strongest insider-buying signal in the dataset: 7 open-market buys, 3 insiders, \$1.7M, cluster score 11. This is a top-tier conviction indicator and upgrades the grade from C to B per the insider-cluster rule. The disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY is -10.9% (underperforming), prox_52w is only 62.4 (not in breakout zone), and volume is weak at 1.58x. The stock is in early recovery, not breakout-insiders are buying the bottom, not chasing a breakout. August 13 earnings is the catalyst test. In a mega-cap-led regime, SMID software faces headwinds. This is a contrarian bet on insider knowledge, not a technical breakout. Watch closely into earnings. Conviction: Medium (upgraded from Low due to insider buying).
Signal: Close above \$12.45 on vol >158% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.58x

